



EV charging robot

Volkswagen has created an EV charging robot that can navigate to your car in a parking lot and charge on demand <https://digit.in/jan20-53>



Galaxy S20

Rumours are about that Samsung might decide to name its next flagship the Galaxy S20 instead of Galaxy S11 <https://digit.in/jan20-54>

Realme Buds Air

Feature-rich true wireless buds priced reasonably

Realme has forayed into the true wireless segment with the Realme Buds Air. The earphones are available at a super aggressive price while still offering premium features. Let's see how they fared in our review.

Design, build and fit

The first thought that springs to mind when you lay eyes on the Realme Buds Air is – Apple AirPods clone since they feature an inordinately similar pipe-style design with 45-degree angled earphone nozzles. The buds are encased in a glossy and compact charging case. The small factor is appreciable, especially since the battery unit is capable of topping up the earphones 4-5 times. The earphones fit inside the case securely with the help of magnets. The case is easily pocketable as well. The Realme Buds Air, like the AirPods, do not have silicone or foam ear tips. This bothered us a fair bit. The earphones have to be shoved in and twisted in order to stay put in smaller ears. The fit can feel loose while walking for those with smaller ears as well. The Buds Air are available in three colours – Black, White and Yellow.

Features

The Realme Buds Air has wireless charging capabilities. The case can be charged atop any Qi wireless charger and it takes about 3 hours to charge fully. They are also capable of instantaneous connection to a paired device. The buds automatically find and connect to a paired device. This is achieved via GPP (Google Fast Pair) technology. The Buds Air also come with Wear Detection. Optical sensors are used to automatically pause/play music depending on whether the buds are inside the ear or not. This feature was a bit slow and didn't work all the time. Realme also



Price
₹3,999



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added a low latency gaming mode that kicks in during video playback too. This resulted in gaming and video feedback with extremely low latency. Additional features include Bluetooth 5.0, ENC (environmental noise cancellation), touch controls, and voice assistant access.

Controls

The Buds Air have touch controls, accessible by tapping the back of the earbuds, over the curved body. Due to the curvature, it is easy to miss-tap, but the inaccuracy was sparingly noticed. The controls are straightforward. Double-tap to pause/play and to answer phone calls and triple-tap to go to the next track. Long press either earbud to activate assistant and end/decline a phone call. Simultaneously long-press both sides to activate or deactivate gaming mode. However, touch controls such as going to the previous track, and more importantly, volume controls are missing.

Performance

The Realme Buds Air feature 12mm dynamic bass boost drivers and a multi-layer composite diaphragm to produce the warm sound profile that suits numerous genres. It has a pleasing

sound signature, dominated by its bass drive. Still, this energetic bass response is surprisingly controlled. In *bad guy* by *Billie Eilish*, the bass thumps have lots of drive, however, the integrity of Eilish's wispy vocals is retained. The mids are slightly under-represented. While vocals sound good, mid-ranged instruments can sound a bit rough around the edges. A track with multiple instruments in this range can sound cacophonous at times, such as *Something From Nothing* by the *Foo Fighters*. Highs are represented decently and tracks such as *Serotonina* by *Highly Suspect* are a pleasant listen. Call quality and microphone performance are average. Battery life, on the other hand, is quite competent. While it features a measly company claim of 3 hours on the buds themselves, the charging case is capable of topping these earphones 4-5 times.

Bottomline

Featuring a mass-appealing boosted bass sound profile, the Realme Buds Air still manages to avoid issues such as auditory masking. The bass is controlled but punchy, the mids are slightly lacking in detail but the highs quite pleasant. Additionally, you also get access to numerous luxurious features such as wear detection, low latency gaming mode, instant connectivity, auto on/off, touch controls and most importantly, wireless charging. At a highly competitive price point of ₹3,999, the Realme Buds Air is an ideal purchase for casual listeners looking for a reasonably-priced pair of true wireless earphones.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIP: R1 Headphone Chips | CONTROLS: Touch | CALLING: Dual Mic, ENC | CONNECTIVITY: Bluetooth 5.0, GPP (Google Fast Pair Technology) | RANGE: 10 meters | WEIGHT: 42.3 g | WEIGHT (PER BUD): 4.2 g | CHARGING: Type-C, supports Qi wireless charging | BATTERY: Up to 17 Hours Playback | SENSORS: Optical Sensor for Wear Detection | DRIVER: 12mm dynamic bass boost driver

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